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The battery passport is a data supply chain: preparing for 18 February 2027

What Turkish battery, e-mobility and energy-storage manufacturers need in place before EU buyers scan the QR code.

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Executive summary

1. Under the EU Batteries Regulation, Regulation (EU) 2023/1542, all batteries placed on the EU market must carry a QR code from 18 February 2027. For electric-vehicle batteries, light means of transport batteries and industrial batteries above 2 kWh, that code must lead to a digital battery passport.
2. The passport is not a label but a data set: identity, composition, carbon footprint, performance and durability, and, over time, recycled content. Much of that data sits with cell suppliers, material suppliers and test laboratories, not with the company whose name is on the pack.
3. Due diligence obligations on cobalt, lithium, nickel and natural graphite follow from 18 August 2027 for larger operators. Exporters who start now can choose how to gather this data. Those who start late will accept whatever their buyers prescribe.

What has changed

The Batteries Regulation has applied since February 2024 and replaced the Batteries Directive in August 2025. Its obligations arrive in stages, and the next group lands on 18 February 2027: QR codes on all batteries, the digital battery passport for the categories above, and removability rules that require portable batteries in appliances to be removable by the user, with limited exceptions.

The obligations fall on the economic operator that places the battery on the EU market. For a Turkish manufacturer that exports under its own name, that may be the manufacturer itself or its EU importer, depending on how the sale is structured. Either way the data has to come from the manufacturer’s supply chain.

Due diligence on the sourcing of cobalt, natural graphite, lithium and nickel was postponed to 18 August 2027. It applies to operators above a net turnover threshold of 40 million euros, and further simplification proposals were under discussion in 2026. Carbon-footprint declarations are being phased in by battery category as the supporting delegated and implementing acts are adopted.

The decision behind the requirement

The passport makes battery data portable. A buyer, a regulator or a recycler can read it without asking you. That raises the value of accurate data and the cost of inconsistent data, because

figures given in a tender, a datasheet and a passport will be compared.

The practical decisions are about ownership and sourcing. Which data do we generate ourselves, which must come from cell and material suppliers, and on what contractual terms? Which passport service will we use, and who in the business updates the record when a supplier or chemistry changes?

For contract manufacturers and component suppliers the question is different but just as commercial: whether to offer passport-ready data as part of the product, and whether customers will pay for it or simply expect it.

Five common misreadings

“The battery passport is our EU importer’s job.” The importer may be legally responsible, but it cannot complete the passport without your data.

“A QR code on the label is enough.” For EV, LMT and industrial batteries above 2 kWh the code must link to a passport with defined content and access rights.

“Due diligence does not concern us because we are below the threshold.” Your larger EU customers will be in scope, and they will ask their suppliers for sourcing information.

“The carbon footprint is one number we can estimate.” It must follow the method set out in delegated acts and be supported by data that can be checked.

“We can prepare in the last quarter.” Supplier data requests, system choices and test results take months. Products shipped from February 2027 need the passport on the day they ship.

Questions for the leadership team

1. Which of our battery products fall into the EV, LMT or industrial above 2 kWh categories?
2. Who is the economic operator placing each product on the EU market?
3. Which passport data do we hold, and which must come from cell and material suppliers?
4. Do our supplier contracts oblige them to provide that data, and in what format?
5. Which products contain portable batteries affected by the removability rules?
6. Are our larger EU customers in scope for due diligence, and what have they asked for?
7. Which passport platform or service will we use, and who maintains the records?
8. How will we keep datasheets, tenders and passport data consistent?

What a good first step produces

A useful first step is a data map for one product family: every passport field, where its data comes from, how reliable it is and who owns it. It should leave the leadership team with a list of gaps, the supplier requests to send now, and a decision on the passport service.

Ganrich Advisory runs this as a focused readiness review with your engineering, purchasing and export teams, and works alongside accredited laboratories and legal counsel where tests or formal advice are needed. We share the working method in a conversation rather than in print, because it depends on the chemistry and the supply chain.

Start a conversation

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About this paper. This paper reflects official sources checked on 23–24 October 2026. It is general information, not legal, customs, tax or engineering advice. Rules, thresholds and dates change; confirm them against official sources before acting. It describes no client work or results.

Sources: Regulation (EU) 2023/1542 concerning batteries and waste batteries: eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2023/1542/oj · European Commission, Batteries: environment.ec.europa.eu/topics/waste-and-recycling/batteries_en

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